Microsoft Word vs. Google Docs

A comprehensive, evidence-backed demonstration document

Positioning thesis

Word provides the real-time collaboration people expect from modern cloud editors while adding deeper professional document production, formal review, rich desktop features, enterprise security, automation, accessibility, and file-format control.

Prepared for	**Executive / Sales / IT decision-makers**
Prepared by	Microsoft Word capability team
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Document purpose	Prove “all they have plus more” with Word features embedded in this .docx
Status	Draft for review – use Track Changes and comments for sign-off

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Tip: In Word, right-click the Table of Contents and choose "Update Field" to refresh page numbers.

1. Executive summary

Microsoft Word should be positioned as the premium document platform: it matches the cloud collaboration benefits commonly associated with Google Docs, then extends beyond them with mature legal-grade review, long-document production, advanced layout, enterprise-grade protection, automation, accessibility, and integration across Microsoft 365.

- Parity: real-time coauthoring, comments, @mentions, sharing links, version history, autosave, templates, spelling/grammar help, and web access.
- Word advantage: Track Changes controls, compare/combine, mail merge, advanced styles, captions/ cross-references, indexes, custom fields, content controls, macros/add-ins, protected documents, sensitivity labels, and richer desktop publishing features.
- Enterprise advantage: integration with SharePoint, OneDrive, Teams, Purview, Copilot, Outlook, Excel, PowerPoint, Power Automate, and Microsoft security/compliance workflows.

Bottom line

Google Docs is excellent for lightweight browser-first collaboration. Word is built for the full lifecycle: brainstorming, drafting, formal review, publication, records retention, compliance, and reuse.

2. Evidence base and source notes

Source	What it supports	Link
Microsoft Support – Track Changes in Word	Word supports Track Changes views, accepting/rejecting changes, author colors, and locking tracking.	Open source
Microsoft Word Blog – secure collaboration in Word	Word collaboration uses OneDrive/SharePoint with coauthoring, comments, track changes, version history, secure sharing, and access levels.	Open source
Microsoft Learn – sensitivity labels	Microsoft Purview sensitivity labels can classify and protect content with encryption, markings, and access restrictions in Office apps.	Open source